

Martijn Scholten

Freelance Senior Platform Engineer

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Profile

Senior Platform Engineer with 12+ years of hands-on experience designing, building and operating cloud-native platforms on AWS, Kubernetes and OpenShift. I go deep on infrastructure: containerization, IaC, CI/CD pipelines, observability and everything that keeps platforms stable, secure and scalable, leveraging AI tooling to accelerate developer workflows and platform operations.

Proven technical leader across startups and enterprises, owning architecture decisions, guiding engineers on implementation approaches, and aligning with stakeholders on technical direction. Not a manager, but the engineer who makes sure we're building the right thing, the right way. From greenfield to migration.

Core Skills

Container Technologies	Kubernetes, OpenShift (ROSA, ARO & On-prem), EKS, K3s, Docker
Public Cloud	AWS (Primary) & Azure
Infrastructure as Code	Terraform, AWS CDK, CloudFormation
CI/CD & GitOps	ArgoCD, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Tekton
Programming & Scripting	Python, Golang, Bash
Data & Messaging	PostgreSQL, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis
Observability	Prometheus, Grafana, Loki
AI & Tooling	Github Copilot, Claude, MCP, KubeGPT
Leadership & Strategy	Technical Leadership, Architecture Decision Making, Team Guidance, Presales Solutioning, Stakeholder Management, Technical Interviewing

Experience

Senior Platform Engineer Jul 2025 – Present
[Royal Schiphol Group \(Freelance\)](#) Amsterdam

- Translating the platform roadmap into technical epics and tasks, enabling work to be distributed across the engineering team
- Migrating OpenShift across multiple on-premise and Azure clusters, coordinating upgrades with Product Owners and Team Leads across 20+ application teams
- Owning the lifecycle management, upgrades and platform elevation for the container platform
- Built and published MCP integrations for Jira and Azure DevOps internally, accelerating developer workflows with AI-assisted tooling
- Technologies: OpenShift, ArgoCD, Terraform, Azure, Azure DevOps

Lead Platform Engineer Oct 2024 – Jun 2025
[NXLog \(Freelance\)](#) Remote

- Led team of 4 engineers, setting technical direction and establishing engineering practices through code reviews and architecture discussions
- Built out AWS Landing Zone with Control Tower; designed and deployed the SaaS platform on EKS from greenfield to production
- Drove containerization initiative across AWS and on-premises environments (VMware, Hyper-V)
- Implemented GitOps workflows with ArgoCD, policy enforcement with Kyverno, and secrets management with Vault
- Coordinated with the CTO and Product Manager to align platform roadmap with business goals
- Technologies: ArgoCD, Kyverno, Longhorn, GitLab CI, Terraform, K3s, Vault, ClickHouse, Ansible

Tech Lead Oct 2023 – Sep 2024
[Nordcloud, an IBM Company](#) Amsterdam

- Led a global Containers Practice of 11 cloud architects and engineers delivering Kubernetes and OpenShift solutions across Europe
- Developed standardized container platform offerings for OpenShift, EKS, GKE and AKS, adopted across multiple client engagements

- Designed reference architectures and delivery blueprints used across greenfield and brownfield engagements
- Provided presales solutioning and technical scoping for new client opportunities locally and abroad
- Collaborated with the CTO on innovative offerings and business cases for new service lines
- Delivered proof-of-concept with KubeGPT for AI-assisted Kubernetes troubleshooting
- Handled hiring, performance reviews and people management responsibilities for the practice

Senior Cloud Architect

Nordcloud, an IBM Company

Aug 2018 – Oct 2023

Amsterdam

- Senior consultant and tech lead of the global Kubernetes practice; designed and delivered container platforms across 10+ client engagements
- Delivered AWS Well-Architected Reviews for Hema, FerroAmp, Finnair, SSH.com
- Consulted across finance, retail, manufacturing and technology sectors
- Conducted technical interviews for engineering headcount and supported placement of consultants on new opportunities
- Mentored junior consultants and delivered internal training on Kubernetes, AWS and DevOps practices

Senior Consultant - Platform Engineer

the LEGO Group (via Nordcloud)

Nov 2021 – Sep 2023

Remote

- Led the technical direction for the container platform, defining architecture standards and technology choices
- Stabilized on-premise Kubernetes (Rancher/RKE); engineered new OpenShift-based container platform
- Built Managed Services layer: Postgres, RabbitMQ, Redis-as-a-Service, adopted by multiple development teams across the organization
- Migrated workloads from RKE to OpenShift using ArgoCD and Github Actions
- Aligned with Engineering Manager and Team Leads to drive platform adoption across the organization
- Technologies: OpenShift, Rancher, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Elasticsearch, GoLang, Python, Terraform, Kyverno

Senior Consultant - Cloud Engineer

SKF Group (via Nordcloud)

Feb 2021 – Oct 2021

Remote

- Developed serverless platform on AWS for ball bearing calculations using Lambda, API Gateway and DynamoDB

Senior Consultant - Cloud Architect

Finnair (via Nordcloud)

Oct 2020 – Jan 2021

Remote

- Re-architected and migrated key workloads from on-premise to AWS using CDK and CloudFormation

Senior Consultant - Cloud Engineer

Bizzdesign (via Nordcloud)

Sep 2019 – Feb 2021

Remote

- Architected multi-tenant Kubernetes platform on EKS serving the core SaaS product; containerized core platform components
- Provided technical guidance to the client's engineering team on Kubernetes best practices and cloud-native patterns
- Technologies: AWS CDK, EKS, ArgoCD, CloudFront, Route53, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki

Senior Consultant - Cloud Engineer

IJsvogel Retail (via Nordcloud)

Oct 2018 – Dec 2019

Remote

- Containerized Magento e-commerce platform on GKE
- Delivered technical training and workshops to the client's development team
- Technologies: Terraform, GKE, Cloud Build, Bash, Python

DevOps Engineer - Full Stack Developer

Simacan B.V.

Jun 2014 – Jul 2018

Amersfoort

- DevOps (2016-2018): Led DevOps team of 3; migrated Heroku to AWS, built out ECS-based infrastructure, 24x7 on-call
- Developer (2014-2016): Built Simacan Control Tower and ANWB Traffic Information platform
- Technologies: AWS, ECS, Docker, Terraform, Kafka, Postgres, Python, Bash, Scala, Java

Education

Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science

2009 – 2013

Saxion Hogeschool Enschede

Certifications

Active: AWS Solutions Architect Professional (2024)

Previously: AWS Security Specialty, AWS DevOps Pro, GCP Cloud Architect

Projects

Technical Blog (mrcontainer.nl) - Writing about Kubernetes, platform engineering practices and homelab experiments.

Homelab - Turing Pi cluster running K3s. Self-hosted services, GitOps and automating things that make life easier.